

# LIN, Chia-Wei

Assistante diplômée

Section de langues et civilisations slaves et de l'Asie du Sud

Université de Lausanne

✉ chia-wei.lin@unil.ch

🦋 @chiaweilin.bsky.social

📧 @chiaweilinguistics

📧 unil.academia.edu/chiaweilin

🐙 github.com/chiaweilinunil

🌐 www.linkedin.com/in/chia-wei-lin-636807389/

## Education

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09.2023 – present

### 📖 PhD student, Université de Lausanne

Dissertation project : *The Buddha's Journey to the West — Barlaam and Josaphat in the Eurasian Linguistic Context*

(Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Ingo Strauch)

- Extra courses in linguistics, digital humanities (Unil) and computer science (EPFL)

04.2021 – 09.2023

### 📖 MA, Indo-European Linguistics, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena

MA Thesis title: *The Pahlavi Psalter — Linguistic Commentary with a Synoptic Edition*

(Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Martin J. Kümmel, Dr. Benedikt Peschl)

- Honours Program for Future Researchers 2023

09.2021 – 09.2023

### 📖 MA, Semitic Philology, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena

MA Thesis title: *"Plato Before the Door of India!" — Transcriptions and Translations in al-Birūnī's Taḥqīq mā li-l-Hind*

### 📖 Zertifikat: Georgische Sprach- und Kulturstudien, Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena

Completed courses: Georgian I-IV, seminars on Caucasian linguistics

09.2017 – 02.2021

### 📖 BA, Classical Philology and South Asian Studies, Ruprechts-Karls-Universität Heidelberg

BA Thesis title: *The \*Ārya-vaśiṣṭha-sūtra in Raṣīd ad-Dīn's Ġāmi' at-Tawārīḥ: Text, Translation and Commentary*

(Supervisor: Dr. Mudagamuwe Maithrimurthi, Prof. Dr. Michael Radich).

- Extra courses in Semitic Studies, Assyriology, Jewish Studies, and Buddhist Studies

- Certificate in Celtology (Prof. George Broderick), Universität Mannheim

### 📖 Certificates in machine learning and computer science:

- Deep Learning Specialization (Deeplearning.ai)

- PyTorch for Deep Learning (Deeplearning.ai)

- Natural Language Processing Specialization (Deeplearning.ai)

- Mathematics for Machine Learning and Data Science Specialization (Deeplearning.ai)

- AI for Medicine Specialization (Deeplearning.ai)

- Algorithms Specialization (Stanford Online)

- Digital Signal Processing (Coursera-EPFL)

- Machine Learning Scientist career track (Datacamp)

## Employment

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09.2023 – present

### 📖 Assistante diplômée, Section de langues et civilisations slaves et de l'Asie du Sud, Université de Lausanne

12.2025 – present

### 📖 Social Media Manager (volunteer), *The Digital Orientalist* (digitalorientalist.com)

## Employment (continued)

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- 09.2021 – 09.2023    ■ **Research assistant**, DFG-project “Belegwörterbuch der sabäischen Sprache” (Prof. Dr. Norbert Nebes)
- 09.2019 – 04.2023    ■ **Research assistant**, DFG-project “Intertextuality in the Chinese Buddhist Canon: Computational-Philological Assessment of Sources, Authorship/Translatorship, and Style” (Prof. Dr. Michael Radich)
- 10.2020 – 09.2021    ■ **Research assistant**, DFG-Project “Die Konstruktion japanischer buddhistischer Identitäten in der Begegnung mit Sri Lanka, 1882-1893” (Dr. Stephan Kigensan Licha)
- 02.2018 – 09.2020    ■ **Student assistant**, Professorship for Buddhist Studies, Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg (Prof. Dr. Michael Radich)
- 10.2018 – 03.2019    ■ **Student assistant**, Humboldt Research Fellowship “The Ethics of Empty Beliefs” (Dr. Rafal Stepień)

## Publications

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- 2026    ■ **Chia-Wei Lin** and Diego Luinetti. 2026. Building a Treebank for the Book of Ezra of the Old Georgian Oshki Bible. *Journal of Open Humanities Data*. Forthcoming.
- Ephrem Aboud Ishac, Christine Roughan, Julius Balski, Nima Jamali, Jeanette Kilicci, **Chia-Wei Lin**, Andrei Macar, Branko Malešević, Stefan Marić, Daniele Reano, Rita Sawaya, and Jonathan Stutz. 2026. HTR Winter School 2025 – Syriac, MS Jerusalem, Saint Mark’s Monastery 36. Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18157525>
- 2025    ■ **Chia-Wei Lin**. 2025. The Buddha’s Journey to the West: The Textual Traditions of *Barlaam and Josaphat* from a Linguistic Perspective. *Hualin International Journal of Buddhist Studies*, 8(2):190–224. <https://doi.org/10.15239/hijbs.08.02.08>
- **Chia-Wei Lin**. 2025. Scriptio Buddhica, Interpretatio Islamica: Buddhist Sūtras and Cultural Translation in Rašīd al-Dīn’s Ġāmi‘ al-Tawārīḫ. In Korinna Gonschorek, Marco Pouget, Luis Schäfer, and Nikola Wenner, editors, *Connected Philology: Interdisciplinary Perspectives on Transcultural Encounters*, pages 49–78. De Gruyter, Berlin and Boston. <https://doi.org/10.1515/9783111432861-003>

## Teaching and online reading groups

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- 2026 spring semester    ■ **Littératures moyen-indiennes (niveau 3)** (together with Prof. Ingo Strauch), Université de Lausanne
- **Sanskrit intermédiaire : syntaxe et traduction (niveau 2)** (together with Prof. Ingo Strauch), Université de Lausanne
- 2025 autumn semester    ■ **Sanskrit intermédiaire : lectures de textes (niveau 2)**, Université de Lausanne
- 2025 spring semester    ■ **Langues moyen-indiennes : lecture de textes simples (niveau 2)** (together with Prof. Ingo Strauch), Université de Lausanne
- 2024 autumn semester    ■ **Introduction aux langues moyen-indiennes : grammaire (niveau 1)**, Université de Lausanne
- 2023&24 autumn semester    ■ **Introduction au bouddhisme indien** (teaching assistant of Prof. Ingo Strauch), Université de Lausanne
- 7.11.2025-Present    ■ **Tangut Reading Group**, online
- 15.04.2025-Present    ■ **Pali Jātaka Reading Group**, online
- 15.02.2025-Present    ■ **Old Georgian Reading Group** (together with Dr. Adam Bremer-McCollum), online

## Teaching and online reading groups (continued)

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30.08.2025-Present    📖 Syriac Reading Group, online

## Conference presentations & invited talks

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- 21–25.07.2026    📖 *Chinese Transcriptions of Syriac and Iranian Sources as Evidence for Northwestern Middle Chinese*  
26th biennial conference of the European Association for Chinese Studies (EACS)  
Ca' Foscari University of Venice
- 26–28.03.2026    📖 *Georgian as the Bridge Language: Balavariani and Abukura in the Context of Arabic-Georgian-Greek Translation*  
Translating the Past: Transtemporal Mediations of Central Asia  
University of Wrocław
- 17.01.2026    📖 *Georgian Oshki Bible Ezra as a translation from Armenian ქართული ოშკის ბიბლია: ეზრა წიგნის სომხურიდან თარგმანი* (together with Dr. Diego Luinetti)  
International Scientific Conference dedicated to Academician Mzekala Shanidze  
online
- 8–12.09.2025    📖 *Towards a typology of orthography of Indic loanwords in Mainland Southeast Asian Languages*  
35. Deutscher Orientalistentag  
Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg
- 📖 *Diagnostic linguistic features of Christian Old Georgian texts translated from Arabic*  
35. Deutscher Orientalistentag  
Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg
- 📖 *Aramaeograms and Syriac loanwords in the Middle Persian Psalter in light of the world's heterographic traditions*  
35. Deutscher Orientalistentag  
Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg
- 11–13.06.2025    📖 *Pattern replication and Semitic syntax as diagnostic features for identifying medieval Arabic-Georgian translations*  
Caucasian Linguistics: Recent Advances and Emerging Topics  
Maison Internationale des Langues et des Cultures, Lyon
- 04–06.06.2025    📖 *Multilingual Encounters in the Buddha Biography in Rašīd al-Dīn's Compendium of Chronicles*  
Translation and Multilingualism in Mongol and Post-Mongol Eurasia  
Universität Münster
- 23.05.2025    📖 Chair of Session III: Tangut in Situ  
Tangut and Qiangic in situ  
Institute d'études avancées de Paris
- 16.05.2025    📖 *Diagnostic linguistic features for identifying medieval Georgian translations from Arabic sources*  
PhD Day 2025  
Conférence universitaire de Suisse occidentale
- 11.03.2025    📖 *The Jātaka Stories in the Balavariani*  
Atelier de recherche SLAS  
Université de Lausanne
- 28.11.2024    📖 *Syriac and Iranic Influences on Chinese Jingjiao Documents*  
Sinology Colloquium  
Universität Zürich

## Conference presentations & invited talks (continued)

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- 14–16.11.2024     ***al-Bīrūnī on Metempsychosis and his Greek and Sanskrit Sources***  
La métempsychose en Islam  
Aix-Marseille Université
- 17–19.10.2024     ***Translating the Buddha's Life Story into Georgian —Balavariani in the Eurasian linguistic context***  
Diverse Lives: Narratives of Śākyamuni Buddha in Text and Image  
Musée du Mariemont
- 10–11.10.2024     ***Linguistic features and "Semiticisms" in Arabic-Georgian Translations — with focus on Balavariani***  
Approche linguistique des traductions entre langues anciennes: l'exemple des traductions du corpus bouddhiques  
Aix-Marseille Université
- 30.08–01.09.2024     ***The Buddha's Journey to the West: The textual tradition of Barlaam and Josaphat***  
When Himalaya Meets the Alps: The Past, Present and Future of Asia-Europe Buddhist and Other Religious Exchanges  
University of Cambridge
- 17–26.07.2024     ***The Buddha in Caucasus: Balavariani in the Eurasian Linguistic Context***  
7th International Summer School Georgian Manuscript  
Korneli Kekelidze National Centre of Manuscripts
- 04.06.2024     ***Le Bouddha au Caucase: Traduire la biographie du Bouddha en géorgien***  
Les défis de la relève en linguistique et sciences du langage  
CLSL, Université de Lausanne
- 26.03.2024     ***The Buddha's Journey to the West — Barlaam and Josaphat in the Eurasian Linguistic Context***  
Les défis de la relève en linguistique et sciences du langage  
CLSL, Université de Lausanne
- 07–08.12.2023     ***Pahlavi Psalter, Psalter Pahlavi – Reconsidering the Aramaeograms in the Pahlavi Psalter***  
Conceptualising Sacred Languages and Their Visual Inimitability  
SOAS, University of London
- 14–16.06.2023     ***Scriptio buddhica, interpretatio islamica—The \*Ārya- vasiṣṭha-sūtra in Rašīd al-Din's Ġāmi' at-Tawārīḥ***  
International Conference: Beyond Comparison  
IDK Philology, LMU München
- 27.04.2023     ***Scriptio buddhica, interpretatio islamica—The \*Ārya- vasiṣṭha-sūtra in Rašīd al-Din's Ġāmi' at-Tawārīḥ***  
Colloquium Kalīla wa-Dimna – AnonymClassic  
Fachbereich Arabistik, Freie Universität Berlin

## Workshops

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- 11.12–13.12.2025     **HTR Winter School 2025: Syriac Group**  
Österreichische Akademie der Wissenschaften, Vienna
- 27.10–01.11.2025     **Doctoral school Current Developments in Research on Middle Chinese and Buddhist Hybrid Chinese**  
Presentation: Syriac and Iranian Influences on Chinese Jingjiao Documents  
Universiteit Gent

## Workshops (continued)

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- 21.07–21.08.2025     **Leiden Summer School in Languages and Linguistics**  
Courses: An Introduction to Arabic Paleography and Epigraphy; Comparative Semitics  
Universiteit Leiden & online
- 21–25.07.2025     **Coptic Summer School**  
Advanced Coptic  
Facoltà Valdese di Teologia, Rome & online
- 10–19.07.2025     **Université d'été en langues de l'orient**  
Égyptien démotique; Métrique arabe ('arūd)  
Venice International University
- 16–28.06.2025     **Summer School for Ancient Trans-Himalayan Languages**  
Tangut, Old Tibetan, Old Chinese, Newar  
Trinity College Dublin
- 28–31.01.2025     **Tradurre l'India. Itinerari linguistici, letterari e religiosi nelle varietà del medio indiano**  
Aśoka Gāndhārī, Pāli, Apabhraṃśa  
Università di bologna
- 02–07.09.2024     **6th International Summer School for Indo-European Linguistics**  
Anatolian, Avestan, Mycenaean, Italic, Indo-European Mythology and Poetics  
Poster:  
Università di Pavia
- 19–30.08.2024     **Language and Culture in the Borderlands of the Eastern Silk Road**  
Bactrian, Tocharian, Tangut, Gandhari  
Universität Wien
- 14–27.02.2024     **Norms of Pāṇini's grammar and Vedic linguistic praxis**  
Università degli Studi di Cagliari
- 04.01–02.02.2024     **Lithuanian Language and Culture Winter Course 2024**  
Scholarship awarded by Lithuanian government  
Kauno fakultetas, Vilniaus Universitetas
- 25–28.09.2023     **Qur'ānic manuscripts past and present: Cataloging and digital tools**  
BBAW & Staatsbibliothek Berlin
- 24–28.09.2023     **International Summer School: Forms of Heteronomous Texts in Antiquity and Byzantium and Methods of Research**  
Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena
- 09–18.08.2023     **TACL Summer School**  
Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg
- 24–27.07.2023     **Erste Sommerschule für Syrische Sprache und Literatur**  
Goethe Universität Frankfurt
- 18–23.02.2023     **Masterclass Cuneiform Epigraphy**  
Ruprecht-Karls-Universität Heidelberg
- 19–23.07.2023     **Jena Summer School for Indo-European Linguistics**  
Classical Armenian  
Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena

## Languages

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- Modern Languages     **Native:** Mandarin Chinese, Taiwanese Minnan  
**Fluent:** English, German, French  
**Reading:** Japanese, Italian

## Languages (continued)

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Philological Languages

■ **Focus of Research:**

Vedic/Classical/Buddhist Hybrid Sanskrit, Pali & Middle Indic, Middle Persian, Ancient and Medieval Greek, Classical Syriac, Classical Arabic, Old and Middle Georgian, Classical and Middle Armenian

**Intermediate:**

Classical Latin, Biblical Hebrew, Classical Chinese, Classical Tibetan, Tangut, Coptic, Akkadian, Rabbinic Hebrew & Medieval Aramaic dialects, Classical Ethiopic

## Digital skills

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- Microsoft Office, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, HTML, JavaScript, XML-TEI, SQL  
C++, Python, PyTorch, Tensorflow (with knowledge of NLP, computer vision, machine learning and deep learning)

## Research interests

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- Christian and Buddhist translations on the Silk Road
- Translations of Greek and Indian sciences into Arabic and Syriac
- History of linguistics and mathematics (Graeco-Arabic, Indic, Sinitic)
- Language contact on the Silk Road
- Language contact between Indic and Southeast Asian languages
- Languages of Caucasus (esp. Armenian and Georgian)
- Historical linguistics of Indo-Iranian languages
- Historical linguistics of Arabic and Aramaic languages
- Natural language processing (NLP) and computational linguistics for ancient languages
- Optical character recognition (OCR) and handwritten text recognition (HTR) for historical manuscripts